

Planner Phase 1 Guidance — Situational Awareness and Near-Term Plan

Purpose

Before building a comprehensive master plan, first develop a thorough understanding of the project and create a practical near-term roadmap.

The immediate priority is:

1. Complete the minimal model
2. Generate non-obvious predictions
3. Validate those predictions where possible
4. Write and submit the core manuscript

Future network-science extensions, dissertation expansion, and broader research-program planning should be tracked but not allowed to distract from these objectives.

Primary Deliverable

Produce:

PROJECT_STATUS_AND_NEAR_TERM_PLAN.md

The document should answer:

Current State

- What has already been established?
- What findings appear robust?
- What remains uncertain?
- What assumptions are currently carrying the most weight?

Domain Status

For each domain:

- Army
- Basketball
- Academia

Summarize:

- current findings
- confidence level
- unresolved issues

- analyses still underway

Modeling Status

Summarize:

- current minimal model
- demonstrated capabilities
- known weaknesses
- outstanding questions

Predictions

Identify:

- candidate predictions
- prediction readiness
- required validation work

Manuscript Readiness

Identify:

- sections already supported
- sections requiring additional evidence
- risks to publication

Recommended Near-Term Sequence

Recommend the shortest path toward:

- completed model
- prediction generation
- manuscript draft
- manuscript submission

Explicit Deferrals

Identify work that should be deferred until after the core manuscript is complete.

Important Constraint

When evaluating opportunities, prefer:

Completion > Expansion

Validation > Complexity

Publication > Exploration